

User Documentation for the Group 3 ELEN3020A Morabaraba

Online Multiplayer Platform

ELEN3020A – Group 3

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Karen Cheng (2658083)

Akiria Chetty (2801838)

Joanna Chronis (2817173)

1. Introduction

This is a user guide for the Morabaraba online platform developed for the ELEN3020A software project. It is a two-player online game that functions in a multiplayer environment with full Morabaraba rule enforcement, as well as additional functions such as timers and user-statistics tracking.

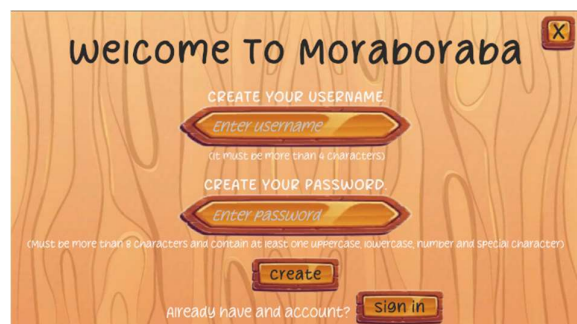
This guide explains how to install, launch, and use the application. It also provides an overview of the gameplay mechanics, rules and troubleshooting information users may need when interacting with the project application.

2. Installing the Game

- Download the zip file containing the application and extract the file.
- Open the application and play the game.

3. Logging in

Once installed, the game opens on the “Login” screen. If the player does not have a username or password, they must click the “Create Username and Password” button at the bottom of the screen. This redirects them to the “Create Username and Password” screen, where they can make their own username and password following specific instructions. Once created, players need to go back to the “Login” screen, where they will re-enter their details. If their details are correct, they can move on to the multiplayer section.



4. Multiplayer Instructions



Once players have successfully logged in or created their accounts, they must select the role they want to play—either the host or the guest—on the main page and press the corresponding button.

As the Host, the player will:



- Give their guest the generated lobby code to allow them to join the host's lobby.
- Select their desired game type and game timer: either timer per turn, overall game time, or casual mode (no timer).
- Start the game once their guest has successfully joined the lobby.

As the Guest, the player will:



- Enter the six-character lobby code received from the host and press join.
- Wait for the host to start the game after successfully joining the lobby.

5. Gameplay Rules

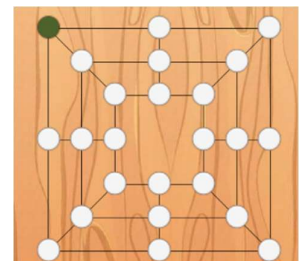
Both Morabaraba and Six Men's Morris have the same rules, with the only difference between the two variants being the number of pieces and the size and configuration of the game board.



The common rules of both Morabaraba and Six Men's Morris, which are both played in three phases, are as follows:

Phase 1: Placement

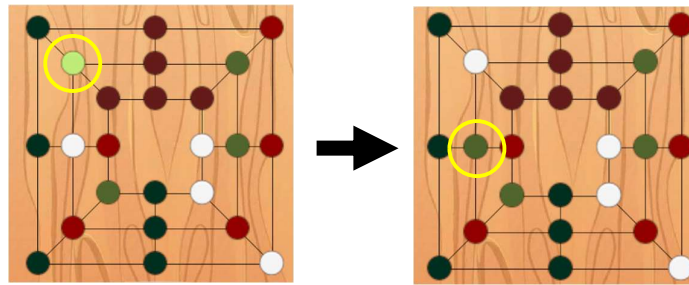
Players take turns placing one piece at a time on any empty point on the game board. During placement, players attempt to form “mills”, consisting of three pieces placed in a row along any straight line on the board.



Phase 2: Movement

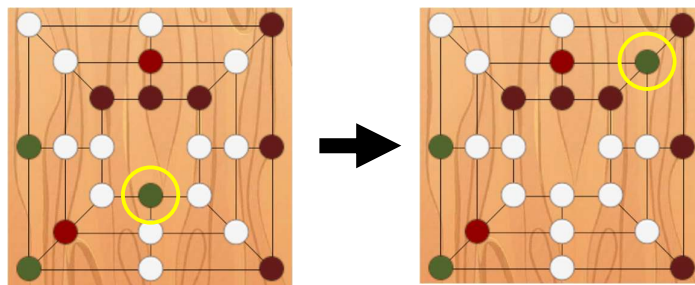
Once all pieces have been placed, players take turns moving their pieces along the lines, one piece at a time, to an adjacent empty point. This is done by selecting the piece they wish to

move and then clicking the point they would like to move it to. Players continue trying to form mills by moving their pieces strategically. (picture 5.3: moved piece: selected and moved)



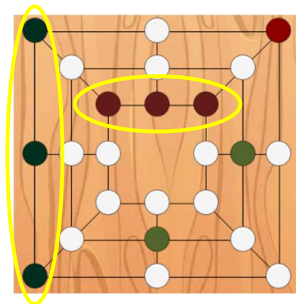
Phase 3: Flying

Once a player is reduced to having only three pieces, that player may “fly” their pieces to any empty point on the board, not just adjacent ones.



Forming Mills and Capturing

Whenever a player forms a mill (three pieces in a row), they immediately capture one of their opponent’s pieces by removing it from the board. A piece that is part of a mill cannot be captured unless there are no other pieces available. The same mill can be “broken” and reformed multiple times to capture additional pieces.



Winning the Game

A player wins by reducing their opponent to two pieces, or by blocking all of their opponent’s possible moves (a position where the opponent cannot make a legal move).

Rewind Function

Both players have a special ability, called rewind. This allows them to rewind the game by two moves. Each player is allowed to use this ability three times within the game should they wish to.

6. Controls

Players use left mouse clicks to interact with the game.

7. Troubleshooting

Please note, this application requires an internet connection to run! Check your internet connection first if a problem arises.

If players encounter an issue joining in the lobby, they should exit the joining menu to reset their lobby status in Unity cloud services and try rejoining.

If they encounter any other issues in the game, such as a button not working or being stuck on a screen for an extended period of time, they should exit the application fully and open it again, as this issue may be due to a glitch in the services running the multiplayer aspect of the platform.